



Study Abroad Report

Dates of stay abroad	from:17/09/2025..... till:..... 30/01/2026
Academic year	2025 / 2026
Type of activity abroad (e.g. exchange, free mover)	 Faculty exchange
Name of university/institution abroad	 Charles University
City/town	 Prague
Country	 Czech Republic
Leiden University study programme:	
- Bachelor or Master	 Bachelor
- Programme name	 International Relations and Organizations
- Faculty	 Behavioral Sciences

Dear Student,

We hope you thoroughly enjoyed your study activities abroad and had a memorable time. Leiden University would very much like to hear about your experiences so we can continue improving our study abroad programmes. Your fellow students who are thinking of studying abroad would also love to read your tips and advice. Remember all the questions you had when you were choosing your destination and making preparations? Well now it's your turn to help out by submitting a detailed study abroad report.

When and how to submit

Within one month of the end of your study activity abroad, upload your study abroad report in the study abroad portal, in the 'upon return' section. Remember that late submission can have consequences for the recognition of your study credits and your scholarship entitlement (if applicable).

Specifications

- Write your report in the table below.
- Your report must be in English.
- Cover all the topics mentioned (if applicable) and provide as much detail as possible - at least 600 words
- Do not include any names or contact details, including your own, for privacy reasons.

Communication with host university or institution: <i>both before and during stay</i>	The international office at Charles University is very helpful. Most of the times they reply quite fast and try to help you. Only during the start of the semester when everyone is arriving, it might take them a couple of days to get back to you. The international office and the university help centre are always open, so you can also go there once you have arrived in Prague.
Welcome and orientation services: <i>compulsory/optional, cost, quality</i>	The orientation day was compulsory to attend. It was a very helpful day; they explained how the university websites, libraries, buildings, worked and gave additional information on for example mental health guidance and police registration. Any orientation "week" activity was free, and it varied from campus tour to getting drinks in the evening. They also had various activities

	planned that were not compulsory like scavenger hunts, sports games, campus tours, city tours.
Accommodation: <i>arrangement, type, location, costs, quality</i>	I stayed at the university dorms that were offered by the university. There are many dorm buildings across the city. I stayed at Koleje Hvezda in Prague 6 which was luckily just renovated. Most of the dorms are near public transport, either metro, tram, or bus, and will either have their own supermarket or are near some. The quality of the dorms really differed per building. There are some that are less clean because they're old. The room size differs per building as well. The ones that are further away from the city centre have bigger rooms available, as well as individual private rooms. Mine was more central but the rooms were smaller. The room in general was tidy and clean. The kitchen and bathrooms get cleaned by cleaners on weekdays which really help improve the overall situation. In most dorms there are laundry rooms, as well as rooms to hang out and chill. Mine even had a bar, cinema room, study room, gym, and a club. The rent was around 200 euros per month.
Costs: <i>living expenses, rent, study materials, insurances, available scholarships</i>	If you decide to stay in the university dorms, the rent is around 200 euro per month. Depending on your lifestyle groceries would cost at minimum 30 euros a month. In Prague, everything is quite cheap except stuff like medicine and electronics. As an EU citizen, the EU Health Card was enough for me to have. Regarding study materials, books are available on their (online) library but there are not many readings to do. The Erasmus grant is around 3000 euros, depending on if you get the green travel scholarship as well, which is very sufficient to live off of.
Visa and residence permit (if applicable): <i>procedures, costs, deadlines</i>	-
Education system: <i>language, differences, quality</i>	The English level of the classes you can take really differed per professor. Most of them had a strong german/Czech accent which made it difficult to understand. Almost all of the classes had some English mistakes either on the slides, exam questions and readings. Following the classes was difficult due to the teacher's English level where it was difficult to understand the context of the class, but in most cases the PowerPoints helped. Depending on the class, you might have more homework to do and submit than that we are used to in Leiden. Overall the content of the classes is good quality and you will learn more in depth stuff than in Leiden. The classes are also smaller around 15 people per class.
Courses and credits: <i>number of courses taken, credit system, recommended courses</i>	I took 6 courses. Charles also uses the ECTS system but not every course is 5 ECTS, it differs. If you do a faculty exchange, you have the possibility to take half of your courses at another faculty. I took half of my courses in the law faculty (constitutional law, critical legal theory, and public international law in European context) which I highly recommend because they go in depth and are really high quality. In the social sciences faculty (your host faculty), I would recommend taking masters courses if you really want to specialize in a subject, they tend to go more in depth about a subject. I took economics of green deal, environmental policy instruments, and feminism in IR. The last two were taught really well and were very enjoyable. Economics of green deal however was taught poorly and organized badly.
Guidance and support:	The international office is very helpful for academic problems regarding ECTS, course registration, Erasmus documents, and learning agreements. They also really help if you have an illness or emergency situation. The quality of help

<i>academic, personal and practical</i>	that the Erasmus/international office offers does differ per faculty. Social sciences were really helpful, while law faculty wasn't as responsive.
Culture, customs and social life	The Erasmus bubble and student life in Prague is very nice and social. Czech people, however, can be a bit xenophobic at times, especially if you are non-European presenting. The traffic rules are also quite strict in Prague, so make sure you always have your transport card or a valid ticket with you. The city is very safe during the day and night, as a girl I didn't feel unsafe by myself at all. There is a big drinking culture in Prague, but absolutely no pressure to participate. If you go to events such as theatres and concerts it is customary to dress fancy. The Czech people aren't very extroverted or like to have small talk but once you befriend them, they are lovely. Knowing a couple of introductory words in Czech will definitely help. Public transport is very easy and is the best way to get anywhere.
Tips and tricks for future students: <i>both for preparations and during stay</i>	Before your trip, I would make sure to bring your valuable electronics and not purchase them in Prague. I would also bring good boots and clothing for the snow/ice. The food/water might get you sick here sometimes so I would bring medicine to help you with that. Revolut can really help if you don't want to pay the conversion fee to Czech crowns a lot, but it is very doable without. It is also useful to have cash by hand during your stay in Prague, to get cash, I would use the bank KB to have the lowest conversion fees. Also if you need to pick between paying in euros or in Czech crowns, always pick Czech crowns for the cheapest price.
Short testimonial: <i>what did your study abroad experience mean to you, what did you gain, greatest memories etc.</i>	My exchange in Prague was the best experience in my life so far. Of course it has its lows and highs but overall it really helps you grow as a person. I gained so much more insight to myself, what I want in life, and who I want in my life. I met the best people and made valuable friendships there. Since it is also central Europe, it's the best place to just get on a train and travel around. My best memories were made with the people I met there and the new places we went on an adventure to.
Anything else you would like to share	

Privacy

When submitting your report in the study abroad portal, you will be asked to grant permission for it to be uploaded in [Leiden University's student reports database](#) in an anonymised form. Here it can be accessed by Leiden University students who are also considering studying abroad. You can find further information on how the data in your study abroad report is stored and used in the [Study Abroad Reports Privacy notice](#).